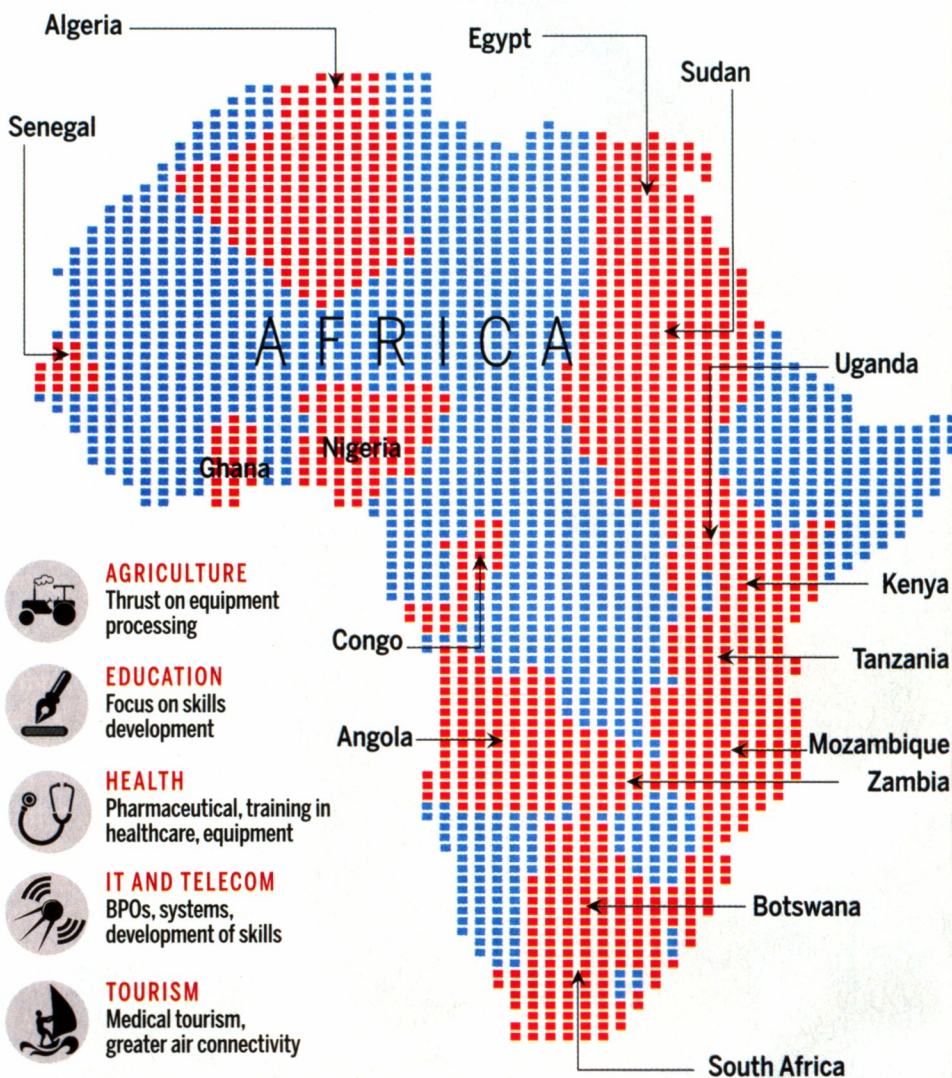


cautious. In addition to a \$5.4-billion line of credit, Rs 2,000 crore was sanctioned by the Cabinet to implement the prime minister's capacity building commitments. "We have always considered the African people close to the Indian ethos. We have a common legacy of a colonial struggle and now we are helping them to improve the quality of their lives by building a win-win partnership for us," External Affairs Minister S.M. Krishna told INDIA TODAY.

Besides old ties, Africa is strategically important for India's energy security. With many countries having untapped oil reserves, countries like Nigeria still account for a major chunk of India's energy requirements and according to some estimates Africa will account for 12 per cent of global oil supplies. India is keen to tap a major chunk of that, given India's burgeoning energy needs. And India Inc's presence underlines this. While the Zain deal is a landmark, the \$10.7-billion will raise the level of Indian investments in Africa to \$16.7 billion. A bulk of the other investments comes from oil and gas majors, truck makers, hotel chains and electronic and white goods manufacturers making a beeline for African shores. They include auto majors Ashok Leyland, Mahindras and Tata Motors. Also present are consumer durables giant Videocon, now a major energy player, liquor baron Vijay Mallya's UB Group, pharma majors Cipla, Dr Reddy's and of course IT companies like NIIT. In fact, India's African trade has grown steadily in recent years with the current levels of trade estimated at \$39 billion. Not only does Africa offer a big market for Indian products, it's also strategically important. Many African countries have large uranium reserves and India is in

THE NEW HOTSPOT

Indian companies are scouting for opportunities in existing and new areas to ramp up economic ties with Africa and take on China



AGRICULTURE
Thrust on equipment processing



EDUCATION
Focus on skills development



HEALTH
Pharmaceutical, training in healthcare, equipment



IT AND TELECOM
BPOs, systems, development of skills



TOURISM
Medical tourism, greater air connectivity



POWER & ENERGY
Generation, distribution and transmission



TRANSPORT
Load-bearing, commercial and passenger vehicles



MINES & MINERALS
Gold, precious stones, hydrocarbons, coal



SMEs
Textiles, renewable energy, gems and jewellery



PRIME MINISTER
MANMOHAN
SINGH WITH
SOUTH AFRICAN
PRESIDENT
JACOB ZUMA



Countries where India is seeking a bigger presence